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JAMES WILD & CO.

BELIZE

THE REEF AND THE JUNGLE, IN FOUR PAGES

When to go, reef or jungle, and six places worth the crossing. Read it over one coffee.

"Jungle first, then the reef."

— JAMES WILD, CHIEF EXPEDITION OFFICER

JAMES WILD & CO.
I KNOW A PLACE
BELIZE · VETTED 2006

HI, I'M IGGI · JAMES'S TRIP-BUILDING BUDDY

Circle what makes you grin, then find **Iggi's Compass** on the Belize page at jameswildco.com. Tell me your month and your crew; the trip takes shape before your coffee's cold. *Never lost. Only scenic.*

01 · WHEN TO GO — PLAN · 02 / 04

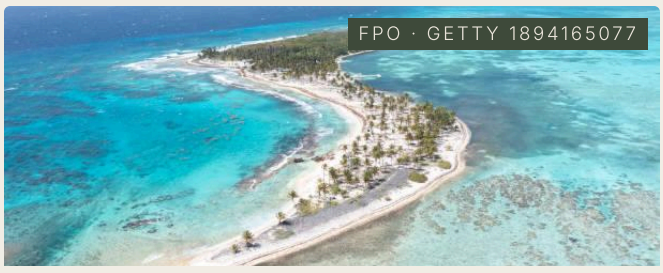
Dry for the reef, green for the jungle

November to May for the dry season and calm seas; June to November for the green season, fewer people and warm water. Storms peak in September.

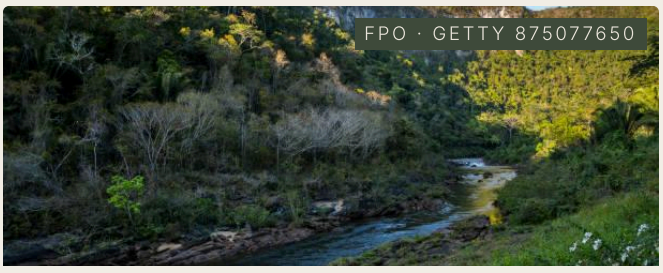
	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Season	dry	dry	dry	dry	dry	green	green	green	green	green	dry	dry
Whale sharks	·	·	●	●	●	●	·	·	·	·	·	·
Scarlet macaws	●	●	●	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	●
Lobster	●	●	·	·	·	·	●	●	●	●	●	●

02 · WHO IT'S FOR — PLAN

IF YOU'RE…	GO	OUR PICK
First-timers	Nov–May	Jungle, then reef · 8 days
Divers	Year-round	Belize Aggressor IV · the Blue Hole
Families	Dec–Apr	Chaa Creek, then Placencia
Couples & honeymooners	Nov–May	Cayo Espanto or Gaia Riverlodge
History lovers	Nov–May	The Maya road, with Tikal
Wildlife lovers	Mar–Jun	Gladden Spit whale sharks



Dry season: Half Moon Caye GETTY IMAGES



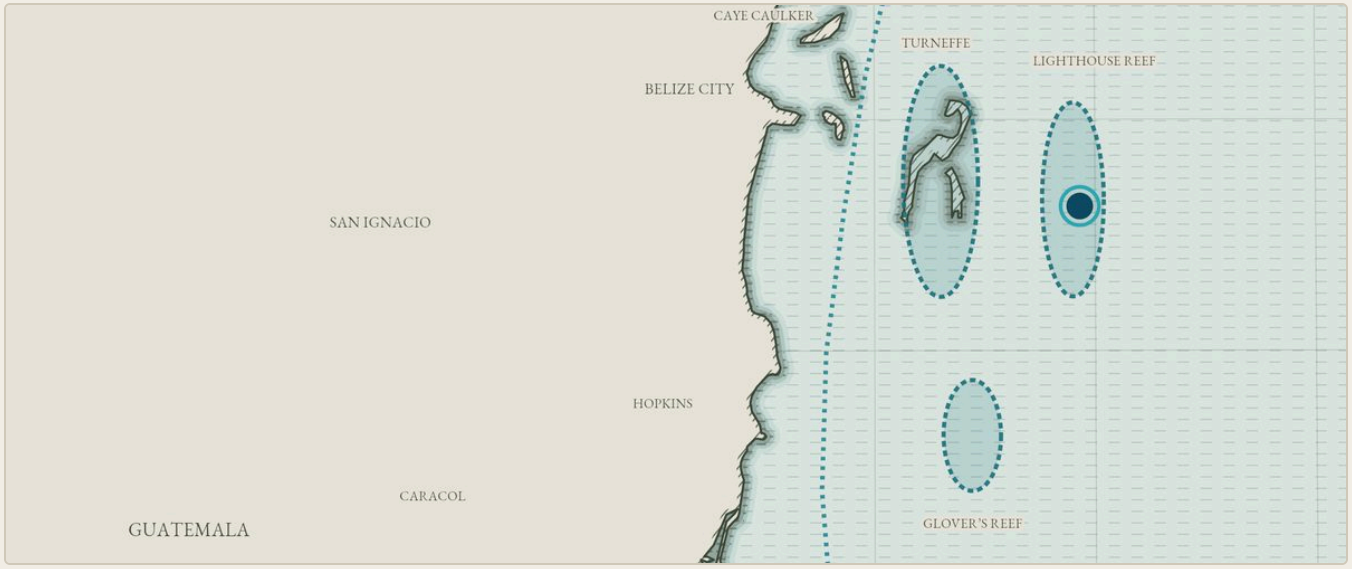
Green season: the Macal River GETTY IMAGES

> *Jungle first, then the reef. Arrive dusty, leave salty.*
> — J. WILD

Six places worth the crossing

The reef in the east, the jungle in the west. Pick one of each and stay three nights in both.

JAMES SAYS DON'T MISS THIS ONE



Ambergris & Caye Caulker
I'LL KNOW SOON

Hol Chan, Shark Ray Alley, sand streets.

Cayo District
I KNOW A PLACE

Rivers, Caracol, ATM, and Tikal next door.

Hopkins & Cockscomb
I'LL KNOW SOON

Garifuna drums and the jaguar preserve.

Lighthouse Reef
I DOVE IT

The Great Blue Hole and Half Moon Caye.

Placencia
I'LL KNOW SOON

Forty-one km of sand; spring whale sharks.

Toledo
I'LL KNOW SOON

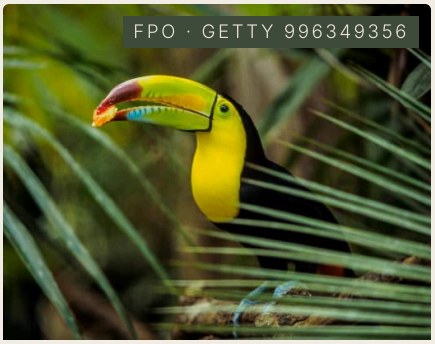
Cacao farms and Maya villages.



Inside the Blue Hole GETTY IMAGES



Caracol, Cayo GETTY IMAGES



The national bird GETTY IMAGES

The rest, in short



GETTY IMAGES

BY SEA

The Blue Hole, properly

Belize Aggressor IV, 7 nights to Turneffe, Lighthouse Reef and Half Moon Caye.

● I DOVE IT · THE BLUE HOLE



GETTY IMAGES

BY LAND

The Maya road

Ten days from Lamanai to Placencia, with Cayo and a day at Tikal.

● I KNOW A PLACE · CAYO & TIKAL



GETTY IMAGES

BOTH

Jungle, then reef

Three nights in Cayo, then four on Ambergris. Eight days.

● I KEEP GOING BACK · THE JAMES WILD WAY

FOUR RULES OF THE ROAD

Look, don’t touch · No cameras in ATM · Drink bottled water · Book Christmas and Easter early

> *I dove the Blue Hole in 2006 and slept at Chaa Creek. Both still hold up.*
> — J. WILD



READY? FOLLOW MY TAIL

Tell Iggi reef or jungle.
James takes it from there.

Tap Iggi’s Compass at jameswildco.com/voyages/belize, or text James on 561.479.6355. Want the long version? Ask for the 20-page field guide.

Already have a travel advisor? We’re happy to work with them. Seasons and wildlife timing are guidance only. Photographs: Getty Images; FPO images are layout comps awaiting licence; Tikal is in Guatemala. Map from Natural Earth data. FL Seller of Travel ST45327 · IATAN 10783883 · Exploring Since 1982. © 2026 James Wild & Co.